

Combat Log — The Heart Knot

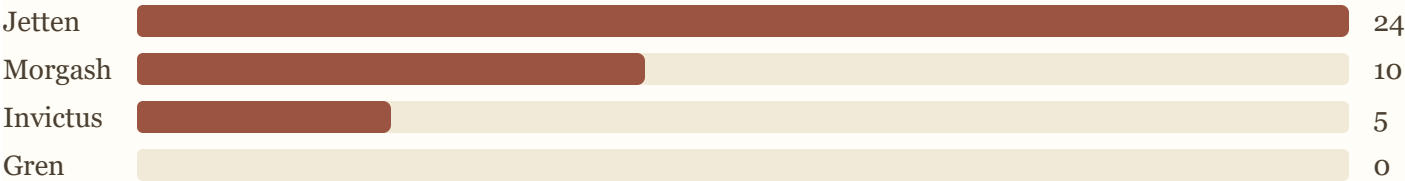
Tuesday, 29 September 2026 · 1 combat · folded from 56 Battle Flow stamped messages of 152

One fight, and not a fight to win: the party had to hold the square for four rounds while the four hearts went into the heart knot one at a time, against three Greenrest Mobs of 350 hit points and five attacks each. They spent almost every action on the hearts, on crowd control and on threats, and almost none on damage.

Four hearts home in four rounds, 39 damage dealt to 1,050 hit points of neighbours — and exactly 39 taken back. Nobody on either side went down, and no heart placement was ever interrupted.

1 • Headline numbers

Damage taken, by character



Jetten stood between the mob and the tree for three rounds and took the Farmhands' only real volley. Gren took nothing: *Shield* turned the one cabbage that would have landed.

CHARACTER	DEALT	TAKEN	HEALED OTHERS	NAT 20S	NAT 1S
Morgash the Gravemaker	35	10	0	0	0
Gren Greenmantle	3	0	8 temp	0	0
Jetten Elisedil	1	24	0	0	0
Invictus	0	5	0	0	0

2 • The heart knot — Town Square, 5 rounds

Initiative: Gren 22, Jetten 14, The Whole Street 8, Invictus 8, Morgash 8, Farmhands 2, Torchbearers 1.

The heart clock: Duskheart placed R1, absorbed R2 • Graveheart R2→R3 • Tideheart R3→R4 (Gren delayed to take the slot) • Thornheart R4→R5, from the saddle of a celestial steed, Athletics 26 vs DC 15.

COMBATANT	DEALT	PER ROUND	ACCURACY	TAKEN
Morgash the Gravemaker	35	7.0	2/2 • 100% (both Ripostes)	10
Gren Greenmantle	3	0.6	1/1 • 100% (nonlethal staff)	0
Jetten Elisedil	1	0.2	caltrops	24
Invictus	0	0	—	5
Greenrest Mob — Farmhands	24	4.8	4/17 • 24%	4
Greenrest Mob — Torchbearers	15	3.0	4/10 • 40%	35
Greenrest Mob — The Whole Street	0	0	never acted (hypnotized)	0

Mildly cold mob dice, not a balance problem. The mobs attack at +6. Their 27 attacks hit 8 times (30%) against party ACs of 15–22; against the targets they actually chose, about 40% was the expectation, and three Farmhand swings went into Invictus's AC 22. One natural 1. The fight was cheap because one mob never acted and a second spent three rounds pinned, not because of the dice.

3 · What the buffs and features actually bought

Every spell, maneuver and feature that touched a number, and what it produced. Ranked by how much it moved the fight.

The big three

Damage prevented or added, by effect

Hypnotic Pattern		~36 prevented
Riposte ×2		35 added
Shield		9 prevented
Heavy Armor Master		9 prevented

- **Hypnotic Pattern was the fight.** The Whole Street failed its save on a 12 and stood slack for all five rounds: about 25 attacks never made. At the night's mob rate (39 damage from 27 attacks, 1.44 per attack) that is roughly 36 damage prevented, and one of three crowds that could never reach the knot.
- **Riposte was the party's damage.** 20 and 15 off two missed pitchforks: 35 of the party's 39. The pike's Push mastery rode both and did nothing to a restrained crowd.
- **Entangle bought three rounds of distance.** The Torchbearers were restrained R2–R4 and failed three escape checks. It held two concentration saves (12, 14) and broke on the third (5, then Heroic Inspiration 7, vs DC 10). The R5 recast was shrugged off (16, 18) and also caught Gren and Jetten in its template.

Maneuvers and features

EFFECT	USES	WHAT IT PRODUCED
Riposte (Morgash)	2	35 damage, both hits
Tactical Mind (Morgash)	1	Intimidation 15 + 4 = 19 vs DC 17 — the Torchbearers paused R1 (~5 attacks not rolled)
Heavy Armor Master (Morgash)	3	9 damage prevented
Find Steed (Invictus)	1	A 60-ft mount to the knot; two Athletics checks to stay seated, 26 and 24
Push mastery (Morgash)	2	Nothing — the target was restrained

Bufs, and what they were worth

BUFF	COST	RETURN
Hypnotic Pattern	3rd-level slot + Innate Sorcery	A whole mob out of the fight, ~36 damage prevented
Entangle	1st-level slot ×2	Torchbearers pinned three rounds; the recast did nothing but restrain Gren
Shield	1st-level slot, reaction	9 damage prevented
Thaumaturgy (advantage on Intimidation)	cantrip	20 vs DC 17 — the Farmhands paused R1. 15 vs DC 25 — nothing.
Spellfire Burst — Bolstering Flames	sorcery point	8 temp HP; no hit on its recipient shows in the ledger
Heroic Inspiration ×2	both charges	Changed nothing. Gren 8 → 8; Jetten 5 → 7 vs DC 10
Aura of Protection	always on	Zero. No party save was rolled inside it
Scorching Ray, Elementalism, three failed Intimidations, caltrops, a nonlethal staff	—	Warning shots and flavour: 4 damage, no outcome changed

Healing that mattered

None was needed. Nobody dropped; Jetten finished lowest, at 22 of 46.

4 • Combat flow — decision speed

The timing stamps, averaged per player across timed decision moments.

CHARACTER	AVG DECISION	TIMED MOMENTS	SLOWEST CALL
Jetten	18.6s	4	24.1s — concentration
Morgash	17.5s	4	24.0s — the Tactical Mind fold
Invictus	15.0s	4	24.0s — a d20 fold
Gren	7.2s	2	9.3s — hold

Decisions were quick. The slow minutes were rulings and targeting (the Hypnotic Pattern opening and the Entangle recast), covered in the mechanics notes.

5 · Economy and flavour

Resources left at the wrap

- **Gren** — slots 1st 3/4, 2nd 2/3, 3rd 1/3; Innate Sorcery 1/2; Heroic Inspiration spent.
- **Jetten** — slots 1st 1/4, 2nd 2/2; Heroic Inspiration spent; HP 22/46.
- **Morgash** — Second Wind 2/3, Superiority 2/4; Action Surge and Adrenaline Rush untouched; HP 68/70.
- **Invictus** — every slot, Lay on Hands 30/30 and both Channel Divinity untouched; HP 48/53.

The night's dice

- **Buff-die flips:** none (no Bless tonight).
- **Natural 20s:** none.
- **Natural 1s:** the Farmhands, once.
- **Advantage rolled:** Invictus ×2 (Thaumaturgy Intimidation) — disadvantage: the Farmhands ×2 (thrown vegetables at range).
- **Death saves:** none.

Generated from the Battle Flow ledger via analyze-combat — read-only scan, reverted applications subtracted — and the session transcript.